

Contact

www.linkedin.com/in/denniszeiler
(LinkedIn)

Top Skills

Venture Capital
Management Consulting
Investment Banking

Languages

Finnish (Native or Bilingual)
English (Full Professional)
French (Full Professional)
Spanish (Elementary)
German (Native or Bilingual)

Dr. Dennis Zeiler

Pre-Seed + Seed VC Investor | xdeck | WHU
Cologne, North Rhine-Westphalia, Germany

Summary

Dennis is a Venture Capital investor at xdeck (www.xdeck.vc). xdeck invests into early-stage B2B tech startups from across Europe. Currently, xdeck has 25 portfolio firms and Dennis actively oversees 13 of them. Dennis raised the first xdeck VC fund of 20m EUR as part of a team of 4 investors. Next to the VC fund, xdeck also operates an equity-free accelerator program which Dennis helped launch and grow to now more than 100 alumni startups and 20 institutional partner firms. Over the last years, Dennis has led more than 10 junior xdeck team members. Dennis is also an active angel investor with currently five portfolio startups. In addition to his investment activities, Dennis is entrepreneurship lecturer at Steinbeis University and WHU - Otto Beisheim School of Management. He holds a Ph.D. degree from WHU and RWTH Aachen. He co-lectures the annual WHU seminar "New Venture Creation", out of which many successful startups have emerged over the last years, including Afilio, PowerUs, and Warehousing1. As a startup coach and sparring partner, Dennis has supported more than 200 startups. Coaching topics include: Idea validation, product feature prioritization, product-market fit, investor readiness, organization building, OKR-based progress tracking, and pitch trainings.

Experience

xdeck

Partner

February 2020 - Present (6 years 6 months)

Cologne, North Rhine-Westphalia, Germany

xdeck is an early-stage venture platform that invests in disruptive B2B tech startups from across Europe.

www.xdeck.vc

BONFRY

Pre-Seed Investor (private Angel Investment)
May 2025 - Present (1 year 3 months)
Berlin, Germany

Plantsalt
Pre-Seed Investor (private Angel Investment)
March 2025 - Present (1 year 5 months)
Berlin, Germany

Victra Sports
Pre-Seed Investor (private Angel Investment)
August 2023 - Present (3 years)
San Francisco, CA

Vamo
Pre-Seed Investor (private Angel Investment)
November 2022 - Present (3 years 9 months)
Cologne, North Rhine-Westphalia, Germany
<https://www.starting-up.de/news/news-investments/vamo-waermepumpen-start-up-sichert-sich-3-mio-euro-finanzierungsrunde.html>

10lift
Pre-Seed Investor (private Angel Investment)
February 2021 - Present (5 years 6 months)
Berlin, Germany
<https://www.pitchdrive.com/stories/liftos-raises-round-0>

LawX
Pre-Seed Investor (VC)
January 2025 - Present (1 year 7 months)
Berlin, Germany

Augmented Industries
Pre-Seed Investor (VC)
December 2024 - Present (1 year 8 months)
Munich
<https://tech.eu/2025/09/30/augmented-industries-raises-eur45m-pre-seed-for-faster-ai-guided-workflows/>

VENMATE
Pre-Seed Investor (VC)

March 2024 - Present (2 years 5 months)

Berlin, Germany

<https://www.startbase.de/news/venmate-erhaelt-600-000-euro-pre-seed-finanzierung/>

Narratic Labs

Pre-Seed Investor (VC)

February 2024 - Present (2 years 6 months)

Berlin, Germany

Packmatic

Seed Investor (VC)

March 2023 - Present (3 years 5 months)

Berlin, Deutschland

<https://www.eu-startups.com/2024/01/berlin-based-packmatic-lands-e15-million-to-scale-its-b2b-digital-packaging-platform-across-europe/>

Plancraft

Seed Investor (VC)

August 2022 - Present (4 years)

Hamburg, Germany

<https://www.eu-startups.com/2024/06/hamburg-based-plancraft-secures-e12-million-to-digitalize-the-european-labor-industry/>

Sunhat

Pre-Seed Investor (VC)

February 2022 - Present (4 years 6 months)

Cologne, North Rhine-Westphalia, Germany

<https://www.eu-startups.com/2024/02/cologne-based-sunhat-extends-seed-round-to-e5-million-to-further-provide-companies-with-sustainability-data/>

Kertos

Pre-Seed Investor (VC)

January 2022 - Present (4 years 7 months)

Munich, Bavaria, Germany

<https://www.eu-startups.com/2023/05/munich-based-kertos-secures-e4-million-to-enhance-automation-for-data-privacy-processes/>

SPECTER Automation

Pre-Seed Investor (VC)

September 2021 - Present (4 years 11 months)

Cologne, North Rhine-Westphalia, Germany

<https://tech.eu/2023/01/31/cologne-construction-tech-startup-specter-automation-raises/>

Floy

Pre-Seed Investor (VC)

July 2021 - Present (5 years 1 month)

Munich, Bavaria, Germany

<https://tech.eu/2023/11/24/floy-s-ai-solution-for-radiology-diagnostics-secures-5-4m-seed-funding/>

2hearts

Member

August 2021 - Present (5 years)

WHU - Otto Beisheim School of Management

Lecturer

August 2016 - Present (10 years)

Vallendar

WHU – Otto Beisheim School of Management is a leading German business school with a focus on entrepreneurship.

<https://www.whu.edu/about-whu/>

WHU Entrepreneurship Center

Startup Coach

August 2016 - November 2020 (4 years 4 months)

Vallendar

WHU Incubator (now WHU Entrepreneurship Center) helps students launch ventures.

<https://www.whu.edu/en/faculty/entrepreneurship-and-innovation-group/entrepreneurship-center/>

Roland Berger Strategy Consultants

Management Consultant

2013 - 2013 (less than a year)

Morgan Stanley

Investment Banking Analyst

2012 - 2012 (less than a year)

Actissia
Startup Incubator
2012 - 2012 (less than a year)

Education

WHU – Otto Beisheim School of Management
Dr. rer. pol., Entrepreneurship

WHU – Otto Beisheim School of Management
Master of Science (M.Sc.), Business & Management

The University of Texas at Austin - The Red McCombs School of
Business
Exchange Semester

Arizona State University - W. P. Carey School of Business
Exchange semester

WHU – Otto Beisheim School of Management
Bachelor of Science (B.Sc.) Business & Management